

Periplaneta americana - type study

7.1 HABITAT AND HABIT

- 7.1 Habitat and habit
- 7.2 External features (Morphology)
- 7.3 Locomotion
- 7.4 Digestive system
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- 7.6 Respiratory system
- 7.7 Excretory system
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Periplaneta americana, was a native of the tropical America. Now it has become a *cosmopolitan* insect. The name *Periplaneta americana* was coined by **Burmeister**. It is usually found in kitchens, hotels, bakeries, warehouses, etc., It is a **nocturnal** insect (it comes out of its hiding places to feed at night times). During the day time it remains inactive and takes rest. Its flattened form of the body enables it to enter small crevices in the floor or walls. It is an **omnivorous** insect, eating all types of food. It locates its food by the sense of smell. *Periplaneta* is a **cursorial** (swift runner) animal.

Classification

Phylum - Arthropoda
Class - Insecta
Order - Orthoptera
Family - Blattidae
Genus - *Periplaneta*
Species - *Americana*

Why do cockroaches take rest during day time?

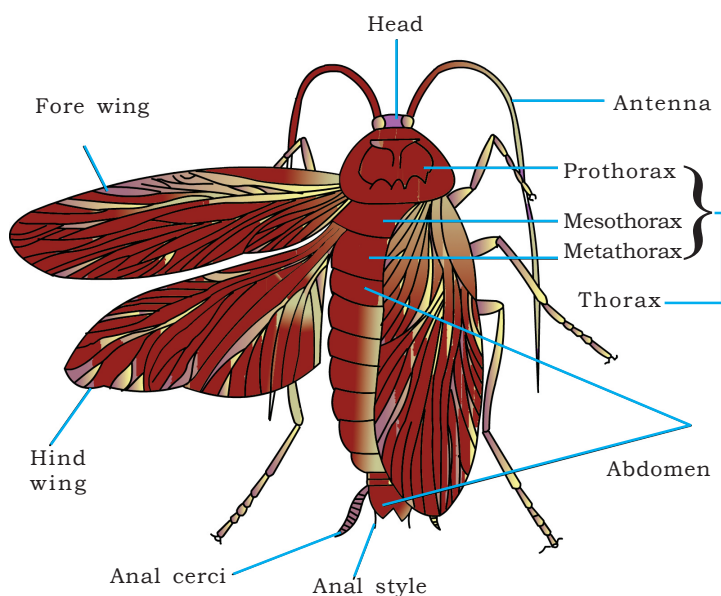


Fig. 7.1 *Periplaneta* (Male): External features

7.2 EXTERNAL FEATURES (MORPHOLOGY)

Cockroach has an elongated, narrow, elliptical, dorso-ventrally depressed body. It exhibits bilateral symmetry. The wings extend beyond the tip of the abdomen in the males. The colour is reddish brown with a light yellow area around the edges of the pronotum. The complete body is externally covered by a **chitinous cuticle** which constitutes the **exoskeleton**. The cuticle is secreted by the underlying cells of the